간판 속 한자어 읽기: 한 글자씩 나누면 뜻이 보여요

Learners use the meaning of common Sino-Korean syllables to guess new words on signs, building guides and notices.

WHAT THIS IS FOR

By the end, you can split a Sino-Korean word on a sign or notice into its syllables and use them to find what a place is, what is not allowed, and what you pay for.

1 KEY SYLLABLES YOU SEE EVERY DAY

1	**입** (enter)	It means going in, as in 입구 (entrance). 예: 입구는 건물 오른쪽에 있어요.
2	**출** (go out)	It means going out, as in 출구 (exit). 예: 지하철 3번 출구로 나오세요.
3	**구** (opening, door)	It names a way in or out, as in 비상구 (emergency exit). 예: 불이 나면 비상구로 나가세요.
4	**실** (room)	At the end of a word, it names a room, as in 회의실 (meeting room). 예: 손님은 회의실에서 기다리고 계세요.
5	**장** (place)	At the end of a word, it is often a large place, as in 주차장 (parking lot). 예: 주차장은 지하에 있어요.
6	**소** (office, spot)	It names a small place for one job, as in 매표소 (ticket office). 예: 표는 매표소에서 사세요.
7	**점** (shop)	At the end of a word, it names a store, as in 편의점 or 서점. 예: 회사 앞 편의점에서 우유를 샀어요.
8	**료** (fee)	It is money you pay for something, as in 입장료 (entrance fee). 예: 아이는 입장료를 안 내요.
9	**금** (not allowed)	It means something is forbidden, as in 금연 (no smoking). 예: 여기는 금연 구역이에요.
10	**식** (eat, meal)	It is about eating, as in 식당 and 식사. 예: 식사 맛있게 하세요.

2 WORD ORDER INSIDE THE WORD

In many Sino-Korean words, the action comes first and the thing comes second, like in English: 등산 = climb + mountain, 독서 = read + book. Native Korean puts the thing first (산에 올라가요). If the first syllable is an action like 입, 출 or 금, read the word as 'enter/exit/forbid + something'. The last syllable often tells you what kind of thing it is (실, 장, 소, 점, 료).

3 WATCH OUT: SAME SOUND, DIFFERENT MEANING

One Korean syllable can come from different Chinese characters. 장 in 주차장 means 'place', but 장 in 반장 (class leader) and 회장 (chairperson) means 'head, leader'. If the word is a person, think 'leader'. If it is somewhere you go, think 'place'.

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You do not need to read Chinese characters. Just learn what each Korean syllable means.

4 YOUR TURN

GUESS WORDS FROM SYLLABLES

Split each word into syllables, use the meanings you learned, and then answer.

1 The last syllable tells you what kind of thing it is. Is it a room, a place or a fee?
①대기실
②수영장
③사용료

2 Choose the right word for the situation:
①You are leaving Korea at the airport. (입국 / 출국)
②A country buys cars from abroad. (수입 / 수출)

3 Fill in the blank with 금, 점 or 실:
①여기서 사진 촬영은 ___지예요.
②이 빵은 역 앞 제과___에서 샀어요.
③진료___ 앞에서 이름을 부를 때까지 기다려 주세요.

4 Read the notice and answer Yes or No. [박물관 안내] 입장료: 무료 · 음식물 반입 금지 · 물품 보관소: 1층
①들어갈 때 돈을 내야 해요.
②안에서 빵을 먹어도 돼요.
③가방은 1층에 맡길 수 있어요.

5 Does 장 mean 'place' or 'head (leader)' here?
①시장에서 과일을 샀어요.
②우리 회사 사장님은 아주 친절하세요.
③삼촌은 자동차 공장에서 일해요.

ANSWERS

1) ① a room (waiting room) ② a place (swimming pool) ③ a fee (usage fee)
2) ① 출국 ② 수입
3) ① 금 (금지) ② 점 (제과점) ③ 실 (진료실)
4) ① No (무료 = free) ② No (음식물 반입 금지 = no food allowed inside) ③ Yes (물품 보관소 = storage for your things)
5) ① place (시장 = market) ② head (사장 = company head) ③ place (공장 = factory)

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